Unit 1 Constitution of India



Learning Objectives

- This chapter discusses the meaning, nature, and significance of the Indian Constitution.
- This chapter provides insights into the philosophy of the Indian Constitution.
- It throws light on the making of the Constitution.
- This chapter identifies the sources that had inspired the framers of the Constitution to improvise and incorporate these into our Constitution.
- This chapter will explain the salient features of the Indian Constitution.
- This chapter will elucidate on the parliamentary type of democracy in India.

1.1 Meaning, Functions and Significance of the Constitution



Nationalism during the colonial period strived not only for political independence but also for territorial integration, constitutionalism and democratization.

India is a culturally diverse country, yet united as a political state. Indians are dependent upon each other in many ways, and they cooperate in many ways. There is a felt need to have specific agreed basic rules and regulations which could facilitate the people of this country to live together. The absence of the basic rules and regulations may imperil the very statehood of India and also make the people feel insecure. Colonial rule was based on Charters, Councils Acts and Government of India Acts. Politics and administration of the newly emerging Indian nation is based on a definite written constitution. The central legislative body was converted into a constituent Assembly (i.e. a constitution Making body). The proposed constitution was meant to bind different matters and different categories of society into one state, facilitating a union of states and cooperation and co-ordination between various segments that constitute the federal narrow.

The most critical function of a constitution is to provide a set of basic rules that allow for optimal coordination amongst members of the state. A

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